

### **Paragraph 1 – The Pill**

The oral contraceptive pill is widely used among adolescents, but its effectiveness and suitability depend on how consistently it is taken. **(Point)** When taken correctly, the pill is more than 99% effective at preventing pregnancy, but in real-world use, effectiveness falls to around 91% because many people forget to take it at the same time every day. Adolescents, in particular, may struggle with the routine of daily pill-taking due to busy school schedules, social commitments, or simply forgetting. **(Evidence)** This means that while the pill is highly effective in theory, in practice its reliability may be lower for teenagers who are still developing habits of consistency and responsibility. **(Explain)** Despite this limitation, the pill has benefits beyond contraception: it can help regulate menstrual cycles, reduce period pain, and improve acne, which can be appealing for young people. Fertility also returns quickly after stopping the pill, making it a flexible option if someone decides to try for pregnancy later. However, a key drawback is that it does not provide any protection against sexually transmitted infections (STIs), so condoms are still needed for safe sex. **(Link)** Overall, the pill can be effective for adolescents who are responsible and able to take it daily, but it may not be the most suitable option for those who struggle with routine use.

### **Paragraph 2 – The Implant (Implanon NXT)**

The contraceptive implant, is often considered more suitable for adolescents because it requires almost no ongoing effort after insertion. **(Point)** This small plastic rod, placed under the skin of the upper arm, is over 99% effective in preventing pregnancy and lasts up to three years. Unlike the pill, it does not depend on daily action, meaning its effectiveness is not reduced by forgetfulness, making it particularly reliable for adolescents who may find a daily routine difficult to maintain. **(Evidence)** This “set-and-forget” quality makes the implant an attractive option for young people, as it removes the stress of remembering contraception and provides long-term peace of mind. **(Explain)** However, there are some drawbacks: insertion requires a minor medical procedure, and some users experience irregular bleeding, spotting, or loss of periods altogether, which may be inconvenient or concerning for adolescents. Like the pill, it does not protect against STIs, so condoms are still required for full protection during sex. Despite these disadvantages, the implant’s convenience, long duration, and high level of reliability make it one of the most suitable options for adolescents who want effective, low-maintenance contraception. **(Link)** In comparison to the pill, the implant offers greater overall effectiveness for teenagers because it reduces the chance of user error and provides continuous, long-term protection.

**The Pill:**

- Widely used among adolescents; effectiveness depends on daily consistency.
- 99% effective if taken perfectly; ~91% effective in real life due to forgetfulness.
- Teens may struggle with daily routine (school, social life, forgetting).
- Benefits: regulates periods, reduces pain, improves acne, fertility returns quickly.
- Drawback: no STI protection; condoms still needed.
- Suitable for responsible teens who can maintain daily routine; less suitable for those who struggle with consistency.

**The Implant (Implanon NXT):**

- Small rod under skin; >99% effective; lasts up to 3 years.
- Requires almost no ongoing effort; effectiveness not reduced by forgetfulness.
- “Set-and-forget” reduces stress and ensures long-term protection.
- Drawbacks: minor insertion procedure, irregular bleeding or no periods, no STI protection.
- Highly suitable for adolescents needing reliable, low-maintenance contraception; more effective than the pill because it avoids user error.